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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: November DP year (1 or 2): 1 Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: March DP year (1 or 2): 2 Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: November DP year (1 or 2): 2 Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

I hold a great interest in design technology as a subject and I have had previous experience in rammed earth prior starting my research. My father constructs stabilished rammed earth walls and wishes to limit his environmental impact, currecntly there is little to no research completed on this topic, therefore it was worth investigating and testing, even if I am unable to come to a final solution. I planned to complete primary research and analysis at home with the appropriate materials while continuing my secondary research at school with access to support from the library and educational staff. I struggled to collect suitable data and evidence on substitutes and their LCA however I have found planning out my research has allowed me to dedicate a respectable of time researching, to ensure I am not prioritising my EE over other areas of study in my learning.

Primary research of testing differing admixtures was reconducted multiple times, differing the cement percentage, however, through trial and error, I produced reliable data which I have further analysed and discussed. Secondary research has remained challenging with limited knowledge available online. Through phone calls and emails with experts in the field I have created a detailed understand of each substitute and the history of SRE.

My supervisor and I have discussed which specific information is necessary to support my EE as I have encountered difficulty working within my initial essay structure. The development of my research question has aided the evaluative process of going through my research. My father's professional knowledge has been a continued source of dependable information and experience in this field.

Going forward, I will collate and present the conclusions of my research and finalise my research question to ensure it covers all aspects of my EE.

During my concluding meeting with my supervisor, after the submission of my final draft, we discussed my gained experiences and feelings regarding my EE. The process of exploring alternatives and consulting experts of their opinions proved to be the most enjoyable aspect. However, I was disheartened by the ineffectiveness of the substitutes, especially the minimal impact of animal proteins on structural integrity ans pressure resistance, despite the centuries-old use. Nevertheless, I was pleasantly surprised by the effectiveness of PFA in meeting environmental, social, and strength requirements. While PFA is relatively expensive compared to other alternatives, its contributing advantages outweight the economic aspect. It also remains more economically viable than cement, which, as sadly anticipated, continues to remain the most effective stabiliser for SRE. If given the opportunity to repeat this research of offer advice to others, I would recommend utilizing industry experts for primary information, considering the limitations of online secondary resources and the influence of different climates and purposes. I am satisfied with my research progress and the knowledge I have acquired, not only in SRE but also in academic research and writing, designing and undertaking experiments, and organizational skills, all of which will greatly benefit me in the future.

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